PANELTEC PTY LTD
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SWMS-62

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	**Supervisor/Foreman**	**Date:**	
High Risk Construction Work:	**UNDERGROUND ASSET LOCATION**	**Project:**	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group - Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. *SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier* **Signature:** ____________		**Location:**	

Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"

Name	Position	☎	Signature	Date
John Guy	Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd	0408 449 023	____________	31/08/2025 – V12.0

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability L *Likely*	 M *Moderate*	 U *Unlikely*
H (1) *(High level of harm)*	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) *(High)*	1	1	2
M (2) *(Medium level of harm)*	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) *(Medium)*	1	2	3
L (3) *(Low level of harm)*	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) *(Low)*	2	3	3

Level	Likelihood / Probability
Likely	Could happen frequently
Moderate	Could happen occasionally
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 **Eliminate the hazard**
Level 2 **Substitute the hazard with something safer.**
Level 3 **Isolate the hazard from people.** **Reduce the risks through engineering controls.**
Level 4 **Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.**
Level 5 **Use personal protective equipment**
The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls in place
Prior to start of works	To prevent injuries or illness to employees.	**1**	1. Check the worksite for additional hazards to those noted in this SWMS and document on site specific induction toolbox form. 2. As required Personal Protective Equipment • Hard Hat • Long Sleeves/Long pants • Safety Glasses • Safety Boots • Hi-Vis Vest/clothing 3. Location of First Aid Kit and Fire Extinguisher • In vehicle 4. Obtain plans from '*Before You Dig Australia'* and other relevant authorities prior to going on site. Some typical examples of work scenarios. #1 Location out on the road reserve or crown land where the asset owners could have their assets. The asset owners should be able to supply plans to work off. # 2 Engaged to locate on private land i.e. house yard, the local swimming pool or park etc, where there may not be any plans available. In this case we do our best to find what we can but always tell the customer that we can or have located all known assets but can't guarantee that we may have not missed something that was not known about. 5. Make sure the locator unit is in good working order.	Workers	**2**
Training and Competency	To prevent injuries or illness to employees	**1**	1. All persons engaged in works are to be trained and competent to perform work in a manner that is safe and without risk to the health & safety of themselves, their workmates or members of the public. 2. Locator to be an endorsed Dial Before You Dig certified locator and Telstra accredited locator.	Workers	**2**
Parking of vehicle and control of pedestrians & traffic. **Set out work area.**	Struck by passing vehicles. Contact with pedestrians.	**1**	1. Ensure traffic management as required is implemented eg witches hats, signs etc. 2. Ensure vehicle is parked legally. 3. Ensure vehicle flashing lights are operating where required. 4. Inform customer where required prior to entering site.	Workers	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls in place
Locating underground assets – cables etc	To prevent injuries to employees	**2**	1. Once plans have been received from the relevant authorities the locating person uses the plans to indicate where the cable should be. 2. Look for evidence of assets, markers, dig evidence etc and ask questions – local knowledge is best. 3. Start proceedings with scan of area, use correct marker paint or pegs, applicable to the asset. 4. These marks are to be used as an indication only and the underground assets shall be positively proved (usually by pot holing with water jetting and vacuum truck) and expose the asset prior to using mechanical digging equipment. 5. Do markup of drawing if required of located items.	Workers	**3**
Discussions with client	To prevent injuries to third party assets	**1**	1. Discuss with client this process is only indicative and proving has still got to be done by someone like potholing an asset to prove it exists in that spot as different types of interference may cloud the locating process or image of what is there.	Workers	**2**
Additional safety issues	Trip, slip hazards.	**2**	1. Clear any obstacles from around all work areas before and as work progresses. 2. Keep pathways clear of trip hazards.	Workers	**3**
	UV Exposure; skin cancer.	**1**	1. Be sun smart wear a broad brimmed hat, sun safety glasses, sun protective clothing and 30+ sunscreen.	Workers	**2**
	Heat Stress	**2**	1. Drink sufficient cool water, take regular breaks & rest in shaded areas as required.	Workers	**3**
	Animal bites including snakes and insects	**2**	1. Always be prepared for the unexpected. 2. Check work area before proceeding with works. 3. Maintain a suitably stocked first aid kit in the truck.	Workers	**3**
	Manual Handling injuries	**2**	1. Always use correct manual handling techniques. 2. Use correct lifting equipment to lift manhole covers. 3. Use lifting aids or two man lifts for heavy or awkward lifts.	Workers	**3**
	Pits & Confined Spaces	**1**	1. No employee is to enter a pit or confined space without confined space entry permit. 2. Do not place any body part, including head or arms into pits.	Workers	**2**

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	**Hazard**	**Risk Class**	**Risk Control Measure**	**Responsible Person/s**	**Risk Class after Controls in place**
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	**1**	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site, assembly location known 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	**2**
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	**2**	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	**3**
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	**2**	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it affectsthem.	Supervisor All	**3**
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	**2**	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	**3**
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	**1**	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	**2**
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	**1**	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in advance in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	**2**

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	**2**	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Use silt traps and cleanup after works in applicable. 5. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 6. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for buildup of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	**3**
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	**1**	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers to be clearly labelled, and Safety Data Sheets retained on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refueling equipment.	Supervisor All	**2**
Visual Impact **Litter and Amenities** **Waste Management**	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	**2**	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day.	Supervisor All	**3**

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory Helmets if and when required	

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.			
• All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card			
• If required Client Site Induction • Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	• Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	• Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required	• Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management
• First Aid certificate training	• Manual Handling training	• Fire Extinguisher training	• Fatigue Management Training

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)			
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022			
Codes of Practice and Other Guides			
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018
Guide for Managing Risks from High Pressure Water Jetting – Safe Work Aust 2012			

Plant & Equipment for this activity

- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site
- Daily maintenance & service checks.
- Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out.
- Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.

List of plant for this Activity

Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):

WORK ACTIVITY BRIEFING

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.